

Champaign, Illinois, 61820

March 16, 2025

Hiring Manager

Becker Friedman Institute for Economics

University of Chicago

Chicago, IL – Hyde Park Campus, Saieh Hall

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Data Science Intern position at Bunge for the Summer of 2025. As a senior majoring in statistics with a minor in mathematics at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, I have developed strong analytical, machine learning, and data visualization skills that align with this role. I am eager to apply my expertise in data-driven decision-making to real-world business challenges in the food and agribusiness sector.

My experience in data science includes working extensively with Python and R to develop predictive models, optimize data pipelines, and generate actionable insights. As an AI/ML intern team leader, I have collaborated with cross-functional teams to analyze large datasets, automate processes, and present findings through interactive dashboards using Tableau and Power BI. Additionally, my role as a consultant at Illinois Business Consulting has strengthened my ability to translate complex data into strategic recommendations, working directly with stakeholders to solve business problems.

Beyond my coursework and internships, I placed 3rd in the 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge, where I conducted statistical and geospatial analyses on the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico. This project enhanced my ability to work with structured and unstructured data, extract meaningful insights, and propose data-driven policy interventions. This experience aligns well with Bunge's mission of leveraging analytics to drive innovation and sustainable business practices.

I am particularly drawn to this internship because of its emphasis on solving real-world business challenges through data science. I welcome the opportunity to contribute my skills in statistical modeling, stakeholder engagement, and data visualization to support Bunge's objectives. Thank you for your time and consideration, and I look forward to the possibility of joining your team.

Sincerely,

Sangjun Ko

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